Artist Brief

Develop an artwork inspired by the natural environment of the Caspian Sea and the Absheron Peninsula. Incorporate materials from the list below. The suggested animal species and groups can inform the imagery, forms and textures of your work.

Material requirements

Every artwork must incorporate at least one material from the list. One listed material is sufficient; several may be combined. These materials may also be used alongside any other artistic materials.

Materials

Material	Where it comes from	What it is
Coquina (shell limestone)	Absheron Peninsula quarries	A porous limestone made mainly of marine shells and shell fragments.
Absheron limestone	Local quarries on the Absheron Peninsula	A porous local limestone and the traditional building stone of Baku and Absheron.
Sand	Absheron beaches	Coastal sand mixed with shell fragments.
Caspian shells	Absheron shore	Empty natural shells, including Caspian cockles.
Salt	Masazir salt lake, Absheron	Crystalline lake salt. The lake water can appear pink.
Mud-volcano clay	Mud volcanoes of Absheron and the Caspian region	Clay-rich mud ejected from underground by mud volcanoes.
Pyrite	Mud-volcano ejecta, Azerbaijan	A sulfide mineral with a metallic appearance, often found as irregular aggregates.
Natural bitumen	Absheron deposits, including Kirmaki, Binagadi and Fatmai	Dark natural hydrocarbon materials, including bitumen and asphaltite.

Caspian wildlife

The following endemic species and groups occur only in the Caspian Sea or its basin and are proposed as references for artistic development. You may select one or several motifs and interpret them through imagery, form, structure or texture.

Species or group	Scientific name
Caspian seal	*Pusa caspica*
Caspian marine shad Brazhnikov's shad	*Alosa braschnikowi*
Bigeye shad Saposhnikovi shad	*Alosa saposchnikowii*
Anchovy kilka	*Clupeonella engrauliformis*
Bigeye kilka Southern Caspian sprat	*Clupeonella grimmi*
Caspian lamprey	*Caspiomyzon wagneri*
Caspian tadpole gobies	*Benthophilus spp.*
Duckbill goby	*Anatirostrum profundorum*
Didacna cockle	*Didacna trigonoides*
Didacna cockle	*Didacna barbotdemarnii*
Didacna cockle	*Didacna pyramidata*
Didacna cockle	*Didacna protracta*
Didacna cockle	*Didacna eichwaldi*
Didacna cockle	*Didacna parallella*
Caspian snails	*Pyrgulinae, Hydrobiidae — various species*

Artwork sizes and quantities

All dimensions are in centimetres, shown as width × height. Dimensions are preliminary and subject to confirmation.

Total: 54 artworks — 39 paintings, 13 freestanding sculptures and 2 wall sculptures.

Paintings — 39 works

Width × height (cm)	Quantity
40 × 60	2
80 × 100	3
100 × 150	3
120 × 100	1
120 × 200	2
120 × 300	4
130 × 100	2
140 × 200	1
145 × 145	1
150 × 200	4
160 × 170	2
180 × 180	1
185 × 120	1
200 × 200	1
200 × 270	2
220 × 200	1
300 × 120	1
300 × 125	1
350 × 180	1
360 × 160	1
460 × 160	2
550 × 300	1
1,200 × 400	1

The 1,200 × 400 cm work is one overall composition to be developed in panels.

Freestanding sculptures — 13 works

The listed width and height are reference dimensions. Depth, base size and final overall dimensions remain to be confirmed.

Width × height (cm)	Quantity
30 × 100	2
30 × 300	1
40 × 130	1
50 × 70	1
60 × 220	2
80 × 200	3
100 × 225	1
130 × 200	2

Wall sculptures — 2 works

Width × height (cm)	Quantity
30 × 100	1
90 × 120	1

What to submit

Please prepare a brief description of your concept, a sketch, a visual reference board created with the help of AI, a list of selected materials, and an explanation of how they will be used. If your work refers to a specific animal, identify the species or group.